

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's attend a business meeting!



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can interrupt politely.
- I can manage a meeting.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever led a meeting? How did you manage it?
- How would you manage a meeting?





Let's Explore!

Polygon hosts a meeting with Mr. Farmani about the **proposal***.

* A "proposal" is a plan which is presented to a company to consider.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Miranda:** Thanks for coming, Mr. Farmani. We're here to discuss and announce our plans for Holly's.
- Farmani:** Before you move on, is this going to be long?
- Miranda:** Not at all. We just have a few things on the agenda. Has everyone got a copy of the agenda? First, we'll address our media plan. Secondly, we have the publicity plan for the new clothing line. Finally, we'll round it off with any questions you may have, Mr. Farmani. Is there anything else you would like to add to the agenda?
- Farmani:** No.
- Miranda:** I don't think so.
- Miranda:** So, I would like to start things off by telling you that our Press Office will not focus on managing 'traditional' media. In other words, we intend to direct our attention to 'new' media, such as Holly's website, internet articles, blogs, and social media platforms.
- Farmani:** Sorry for interrupting, but how will that help my company sell more clothes?
- Miranda:** That's a good question. The future of sales and publicity is going to be through social media - Mebook, Photogram, etc. This will definitely help boost sales, raise brand awareness ...
- Farmani:** Can I stop you there for a second? The Garcias have offered something similar and better. They have their own web portal ...
- Miranda:** If I could just come in here, I'm not sure how this is going to increase sales.
- Farmani:** As I was saying, they are offering not only business-to-consumer sales, but also business-to-business sales, which means other retail stores will be able to sell Holly's new clothing line.





Let's Practice!

Polygon meets with Farmani. What happens in the meeting?

Instructions: Read the dialogue. Underline all the expressions that are used to manage the meeting.

- Janet:** Thanks for coming, Mr. Farmani. We're here to discuss and announce our plans for Holly's.
- Farmani:** Before you move on, is this going to be long?
- Janet:** Not at all. We just have a few things on the agenda. Has everyone got a copy of the agenda? First, we'll address our media plan. Secondly, we have the publicity plan for the new clothing line. Finally, we'll round it off with any questions you may have, Mr. Farmani. Is there anything else you would like to add to the agenda?
- Farmani:** No.
- Miranda:** I don't think so. So, Janet and I would like to start things off by telling you that our Press Office will not focus on managing "traditional" media. In other words, we intend to direct our attention to "new" media, such as Holly's website, internet articles, blogs, and social media platforms.



Let's Practice!

Farmani has something to say, what is it?

Instructions: Use the words from the bank to correctly complete the sentences.

1. Can I just _____ here, before we get started?
2. Before _____, is this going to be long?
3. Sorry _____, but how will that help my company sell more clothes?
4. _____ there for a second? The other company offered us something better.
5. _____ come in here. I'm not sure how this is going to boost sales.
6. _____ for _____, but how will using social media help?
7. Can I just _____ something, Miranda?

Word Bank

- Excuse me
- butting in
- mention
- you move on
- If I could just
- to interrupt
- Can I stop you
- say something



Extension Activity

It's time for a business meeting!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a dialogue between two people at a business meeting.
- The meeting is about the company trying to sell a new product. You can choose the product.
- Use expressions to manage the meeting and interrupt politely.
- Practice your dialogue aloud with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I write a dialogue about a business meeting.

☐ ☐

I use expressions to manage a meeting.

☐ ☐

I use expressions to interrupt politely.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to round off** (verb): to close a meeting with a last item on the agenda
e.g. We'll round off the meeting with any questions you may have.
- **to intend** (verb): to have a course of action as one's purpose or objective
e.g. We intend to conclude the meeting by 12 p.m.
- **to direct** (verb): to aim or focus attention
e.g. We intend to direct our attention to 'new' media, such as websites, blogs and social media platforms.
- **to boost** (verb): to encourage something to improve
e.g. Social media will definitely help boost sales.
- **to raise** (verb): to move to a higher position or level
e.g. To raise brand awareness, try using social media.
- **to increase** (verb): to make greater in amount or size
e.g. Creating a company website is going to increase sales.
- **retail store** (noun): a store that sells goods to the public
e.g. We're going to offer our new clothing line in other retail stores.





Learning Points

Language for Managing a Meeting

The language of meetings is central to business communication. Whether you are holding a meeting or attending one, it is important that you use and understand key language and expressions.

When people get together to talk about important things and make important decisions, they usually have a 'meeting'. Here are some more common patterns:

- A meeting on / about:
We are having a meeting on our marketing issues.
- A meeting with:
That's a point I would like to address during my meeting with Mr. Farmani.
- Hold a meeting:
We're holding a meeting next week to discuss our new marketing strategy.
- Attend a meeting:
Is Farmani attending our meeting on branding?

Opening the meeting	Introducing items on the agenda
• <i>I'd like to welcome everyone to the meeting.</i> • <i>Thank you all for making it at such short notice.</i> • <i>Shall we make a start?</i> • <i>Let's get down to business.</i> • <i>Has everyone got a copy of the agenda?</i> • <i>We're here to discuss ...</i> • <i>The objective of this meeting is to ...</i>	• <i>The first item on the agenda is ...</i> • <i>The first thing we need to look at is ...</i> • <i>The first thing we need to decide on is ...</i> • <i>Now I'd like us to turn to the next point on the agenda.</i> • <i>First, ...</i> • <i>Secondly, ...</i> • <i>Finally, we'll round it off with any questions you may have ...</i>
Welcoming participation	Closing the meeting
• <i>Is there anything else you would like to add to the agenda?</i> • <i>Do you have any ideas, Adriana?</i> • <i>Do you have any suggestions, Maria?</i> • <i>I'd like to hear your thoughts on this, Carol.</i> • <i>What do you think about that, Mark?</i>	• <i>I think that this pretty much brings us to the end of our meeting.</i> • <i>So, I'd like to run briefly through all the points we've discussed.</i> • <i>Thank you all for your contribution to this meeting.</i> • <i>Thank you all for attending today.</i>





Learning Points

Examples:

- *Thanks for coming, Ms. Morehouse.*
- *We're here to discuss our plans for the future of this company.*
- *The first item on the agenda is our SWOT analysis.*
- *First, we'll address our marketing plan.*
- *Secondly, we have the charity events for the clothing line.*
- *Finally, we'll round it off with any questions you may have.*
- *Is there anything else you would like to add to the agenda?*

Language for Interrupting

In a meeting, sometimes you want to stop someone when they are speaking or concentrating on something, to say something you consider important. Here are some ways to interrupt politely:

- *Sorry for interrupting, but ...*
- *Excuse me for butting in, but ...*
- *Can I stop you there for a second?*
- *Can I just say something here?*
- *Can I just mention something?*
- *Before you move on, ...*
- *If I could just come in here.*

